Spine Procedures

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➲ Instructions for Use

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- Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery Procedures
- Sacroiliac Joint Interventions
- Spinal Fusion and Bone Healing Enhancement Products
- Spinal Fusion and Decompression
- Total Artificial Disc Replacement for the Spine

Coverage Rationale

Cervical Spine

Cervical Artificial Disc Replacement

Medicare does not have an NCD for cervical artificial disc replacement. LCDs/LCAs exist and compliance with these policies is required where applicable. For specific LCDs/LCAs, refer to the table for Cervical Artificial Disc Replacement.

For coverage guidelines for states/territories with no LCDs/LCAs, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Total Artificial Disc Replacement for the Spine.

Cervical Spine Fusion Surgery

Medicare does not have a National Coverage Determination (NCD) for cervical spine fusion surgery. Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)/Local Coverage Articles (LCAs) exist and compliance with these policies is required where applicable. For specific LCDs/LCAs, refer to the table for Cervical Spine Fusion Surgery.

Cervical Spine Surgery (Other Non-Fusion Procedures)

Medicare does not have an NCD for cervical spine surgery (other non-fusion procedures). LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Spinal Fusion and Decompression.

Thoracic Spine

Thoracic Spine Surgery

Medicare does not have an NCD for thoracic spine surgery. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Spinal Fusion and Decompression.

Scoliosis or Kyphosis Surgery

Medicare does not have an NCD for scoliosis or kyphosis surgery. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

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For coverage guidelines, refer to the InterQual® CP: Procedures, Scoliosis or Kyphosis Surgery.

Click here to view the InterQual® criteria.

Lumbar Spine

Lumbar Spine Surgery

Medicare does not have an NCD for lumbar spine surgery. LCDs/LCAs exist and compliance with these policies is required where applicable. For specific LCDs/LCAs, refer to the table for Lumbar Spine Surgery.

For coverage guidelines for states/territories with no LCDs/LCAs, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Spinal Fusion and Decompression.

Interlaminar Lumbar Instrumented Fusion (ILIF) Utilizing an Interspinous Process Fusion Device

Medicare does not have an NCD for ILIF utilizing an interspinous process fusion device. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Interspinous Fusion and Decompression Devices.

Spinal Decompression and Interspinous Process Decompression Systems for the Treatment of Lumbar Spinal Stenosis [e.g., Interspinous Process Decompression (IPD)]

Medicare does not have an NCD for spinal decompression and interspinous process decompression systems. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Interspinous Fusion and Decompression Devices.

Percutaneous Lumbar Decompression of Nucleus Pulposus

Medicare does not have an NCD for percutaneous lumbar decompression of nucleus pulposus. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery Procedures.

Sacral Spine

Percutaneous Sacral Augmentation (Sacroplasty)

Medicare does not have an NCD for sacroplasty. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery Procedures.

Percutaneous Minimally Invasive Fusion/Stabilization of the Sacroiliac Joint for the Treatment of Back Pain

Medicare does not have an NCD for percutaneous minimally invasive fusion/stabilization of the sacroiliac joint for the treatment of back pain. LCDs/LCAs exist and compliance with these policies is required where applicable. For specific LCDs/LCAs, refer to the table for Percutaneous Minimally Invasive Fusion/Stabilization of the Sacroiliac Joint for the Treatment of Back Pain.

For coverage guidelines for states/territories with no LCDs/LCAs, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Sacroiliac Joint Interventions.

Annular Closure Devices (ACDs) (e.g., Barricaid Annular Closure Device)

Medicare does not have an NCD for annular closure devices. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Discogenic Pain Treatment.

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Spinal Fusion and Bone Healing Enhancement Products Including Allograft or Synthetic Bone Graft Materials

Medicare does not have an NCD for spinal fusion and bone healing enhancement products including allograft or synthetic bone graft materials. LCDs/LCAs do not exist.

For coverage guidelines, refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Spinal Fusion and Bone Healing Enhancement Products.

Applicable Codes

The following list(s) of procedure and/or diagnosis codes is provided for reference purposes only and may not be all inclusive. Listing of a code in this policy does not imply that the service described by the code is a covered or non-covered health service; however, language may be included in the listing below to indicate if a code is non-covered. Benefit coverage for health services is determined by the member specific benefit plan document and applicable laws that may require coverage for a specific service. The inclusion of a code does not imply any right to reimbursement or guarantee claim payment. Other policies and guidelines may apply.

CPT Code	Description
Cervical Artificial Disc Replacement	
22856	Total disc arthroplasty (artificial disc), anterior approach, including discectomy with end plate preparation (includes osteophytectomy for nerve root or spinal cord decompression and microdissection); single interspace, cervical
22858	Total disc arthroplasty (artificial disc), anterior approach, including discectomy with end plate preparation (includes osteophytectomy for nerve root or spinal cord decompression and microdissection); second level, cervical (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
22861	Revision including replacement of total disc arthroplasty (artificial disc), anterior approach, single interspace; cervical
22899	Unlisted procedure, spine
Cervical Spine Fusion Surgery	
22548	Arthrodesis, anterior transoral or extraoral technique, clivus-C1-C2 (atlas-axis), with or without excision of odontoid process
22551	Arthrodesis, anterior interbody, including disc space preparation, discectomy, osteophytectomy and decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve roots; cervical below C2
22554	Arthrodesis, anterior interbody technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); cervical below C2
22590	Arthrodesis, posterior technique, craniocervical (occiput-C2)
22595	Arthrodesis, posterior technique, atlas-axis (C1-C2)
22600	Arthrodesis, posterior or posterolateral technique, single interspace; cervical below C2 segment
Cervical Spine Surgery (Other Non-Fusion Procedures)	
22210	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 1 vertebral segment; cervical
22220	Osteotomy of spine, including discectomy, anterior approach, single vertebral segment; cervical
22830	Exploration of spinal fusion
22849	Reinsertion of spinal fixation device
22852	Removal of posterior segmental instrumentation
22854	Insertion of intervertebral biomechanical device(s) (e.g., synthetic cage, mesh) with integral anterior instrumentation for device anchoring (e.g., screws, flanges), when performed, to vertebral corpectomy(ies) (vertebral body resection, partial or complete) defect, in conjunction with interbody arthrodesis, each contiguous defect (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
22855	Removal of anterior instrumentation
63001	Laminectomy with exploration and/or decompression of spinal cord and/or cauda equina, without facetectomy, foraminotomy or discectomy (e.g., spinal stenosis), 1 or 2 vertebral segments; cervical

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CPT Code	Description
Cervical Spine Surgery (Other Non-Fusion Procedures)	
63015	Laminectomy with exploration and/or decompression of spinal cord and/or cauda equina, without facetectomy, foraminotomy or discectomy (e.g., spinal stenosis), more than 2 vertebral segments; cervical
63020	Laminotomy (hemilaminectomy), with decompression of nerve root(s), including partial facetectomy, foraminotomy and/or excision of herniated intervertebral disc; 1 interspace, cervical
63040	Laminotomy (hemilaminectomy), with decompression of nerve root(s), including partial facetectomy, foraminotomy and/or excision of herniated intervertebral disc, reexploration, single interspace; cervical
63045	Laminectomy, facetectomy and foraminotomy (unilateral or bilateral with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina and/or nerve root[s], [e.g., spinal or lateral recess stenosis]), single vertebral segment; cervical
63050	Laminoplasty, cervical, with decompression of the spinal cord, 2 or more vertebral segments
63051	Laminoplasty, cervical, with decompression of the spinal cord, 2 or more vertebral segments; with reconstruction of the posterior bony elements (including the application of bridging bone graft and non-segmental fixation devices [e.g., wire, suture, mini plates], when performed)
63075	Discectomy, anterior, with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s), including osteophytectomy; cervical, single interspace
63081	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, anterior approach with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s); cervical, single segment
Thoracic Spine Surgery	
22206	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 3 columns, 1 vertebral segment (e.g., pedicle/vertebral body subtraction); thoracic
22212	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 1 vertebral segment; thoracic
22222	Osteotomy of spine, including discectomy, anterior approach, single vertebral segment; thoracic
22532	Arthrodesis, lateral extracavitary technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); thoracic
22556	Arthrodesis, anterior interbody technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); thoracic
22610	Arthrodesis, posterior or posterolateral technique, single interspace; thoracic (with lateral transverse technique, when performed)
22830	Exploration of spinal fusion
22849	Reinsertion of spinal fixation device
22852	Removal of posterior segmental instrumentation
22854	Insertion of intervertebral biomechanical device(s) (e.g., synthetic cage, mesh) with integral anterior instrumentation for device anchoring (e.g., screws, flanges), when performed, to vertebral corpectomy(ies) (vertebral body resection, partial or complete) defect, in conjunction with interbody arthrodesis, each contiguous defect (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
22855	Removal of anterior instrumentation
63003	Laminectomy with exploration and/or decompression of spinal cord and/or cauda equina, without facetectomy, foraminotomy or discectomy (e.g., spinal stenosis), 1 or 2 vertebral segments; thoracic
63016	Laminectomy with exploration and/or decompression of spinal cord and/or cauda equina, without facetectomy, foraminotomy or discectomy (e.g., spinal stenosis), more than 2 vertebral segments; thoracic
63046	Laminectomy, facetectomy and foraminotomy (unilateral or bilateral with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina and/or nerve root[s], [e.g., spinal or lateral recess stenosis]), single vertebral segment; thoracic
63055	Transpedicular approach with decompression of spinal cord, equina and/or nerve root(s) (e.g., herniated intervertebral disc), single segment; thoracic

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CPT Code	Description
Thoracic Spine Surgery	
63064	Costovertebral approach with decompression of spinal cord or nerve root(s) (e.g., herniated intervertebral disc), thoracic; single segment
63077	Discectomy, anterior, with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s), including osteophytectomy; thoracic, single interspace
63085	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, transthoracic approach with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s); thoracic, single segment
63087	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, combined thoracolumbar approach with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina or nerve root(s), lower thoracic or lumbar; single segment
63090	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, transperitoneal or retroperitoneal approach with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina or nerve root(s), lower thoracic, lumbar, or sacral; single segment
63101	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, lateral extracavitary approach with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s) (e.g., for tumor or retropulsed bone fragments); thoracic, single segment
Scoliosis or Kyphosis Surgery	
22206	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 3 columns, 1 vertebral segment (e.g., pedicle/vertebral body subtraction); thoracic
22207	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 3 columns, 1 vertebral segment (e.g., pedicle/vertebral body subtraction); lumbar
22210	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 1 vertebral segment; cervical
22212	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 1 vertebral segment; thoracic
22214	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 1 vertebral segment; lumbar
22220	Osteotomy of spine, including discectomy, anterior approach, single vertebral segment; cervical
22222	Osteotomy of spine, including discectomy, anterior approach, single vertebral segment; thoracic
22224	Osteotomy of spine, including discectomy, anterior approach, single vertebral segment; lumbar
22800	Arthrodesis, posterior, for spinal deformity, with or without cast; up to 6 vertebral segments
22802	Arthrodesis, posterior, for spinal deformity, with or without cast; 7 to 12 vertebral segments
22804	Arthrodesis, posterior, for spinal deformity, with or without cast; 13 or more vertebral segments
22808	Arthrodesis, anterior, for spinal deformity, with or without cast; 2 to 3 vertebral segments
22810	Arthrodesis, anterior, for spinal deformity, with or without cast; 4 to 7 vertebral segments
22812	Arthrodesis, anterior, for spinal deformity, with or without cast; 8 or more vertebral segments
22818	Kyphectomy, circumferential exposure of spine and resection of vertebral segment(s) (including body and posterior elements); single or 2 segments
22819	Kyphectomy, circumferential exposure of spine and resection of vertebral segment(s) (including body and posterior elements); 3 or more segments
22849	Reinsertion of spinal fixation device
22850	Removal of posterior nonsegmental instrumentation (e.g., Harrington rod)
22852	Removal of posterior segmental instrumentation
22854	Insertion of intervertebral biomechanical device(s) (e.g., synthetic cage, mesh) with integral anterior instrumentation for device anchoring (e.g., screws, flanges), when performed, to vertebral corpectomy(ies) (vertebral body resection, partial or complete) defect, in conjunction with interbody arthrodesis, each contiguous defect (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
22855	Removal of anterior instrumentation
Lumbar Spine Surgery	
22207	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 3 columns, 1 vertebral segment (e.g., pedicle/vertebral body subtraction); lumbar
22214	Osteotomy of spine, posterior or posterolateral approach, 1 vertebral segment; lumbar

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CPT Code	Description
Lumbar Spine Surgery	
22224	Osteotomy of spine, including discectomy, anterior approach, single vertebral segment; lumbar
22533	Arthrodesis, lateral extracavitary technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); lumbar
22558	Arthrodesis, anterior interbody technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); lumbar
22612	Arthrodesis, posterior or posterolateral technique, single interspace; lumbar (with lateral transverse technique, when performed)
22630	Arthrodesis, posterior interbody technique, including laminectomy and/or discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression), single interspace, lumbar
22633	Arthrodesis, combined posterior, or posterolateral technique with posterior interbody technique including laminectomy and/or discectomy sufficient to prepare interspace (other than for decompression), single interspace, lumbar
22830	Exploration of spinal fusion
22849	Reinsertion of spinal fixation device
22852	Removal of posterior segmental instrumentation
22854	Insertion of intervertebral biomechanical device(s) (e.g., synthetic cage, mesh) with integral anterior instrumentation for device anchoring (e.g., screws, flanges), when performed, to vertebral corpectomy(ies) (vertebral body resection, partial or complete) defect, in conjunction with interbody arthrodesis, each contiguous defect (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
22855	Removal of anterior instrumentation
63005	Laminectomy with exploration and/or decompression of spinal cord and/or cauda equina, without facetectomy, foraminotomy or discectomy (e.g., spinal stenosis), 1 or 2 vertebral segments; lumbar, except for spondylolisthesis
63012	Laminectomy with removal of abnormal facets and/or pars inter-articularis with decompression of cauda equina and nerve roots for spondylolisthesis, lumbar (Gill type procedure)
63017	Laminectomy with exploration and/or decompression of spinal cord and/or cauda equina, without facetectomy, foraminotomy or discectomy (e.g., spinal stenosis), more than 2 vertebral segments; lumbar
63030	Laminotomy (hemilaminectomy), with decompression of nerve root(s), including partial facetectomy, foraminotomy and/or excision of herniated intervertebral disc; 1 interspace, lumbar
63042	Laminotomy (hemilaminectomy), with decompression of nerve root(s), including partial facetectomy, foraminotomy and/or excision of herniated intervertebral disc, reexploration, single interspace; lumbar
63047	Laminectomy, facetectomy and foraminotomy (unilateral or bilateral with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina and/or nerve root[s], [e.g., spinal or lateral recess stenosis]), single vertebral segment; lumbar
63056	Transpedicular approach with decompression of spinal cord, equina and/or nerve root(s) (e.g., herniated intervertebral disc), single segment; lumbar (including transfacet, or lateral extraforaminal approach) (e.g., far lateral herniated intervertebral disc)
63087	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, combined thoracolumbar approach with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina or nerve root(s), lower thoracic or lumbar; single segment
63090	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, transperitoneal or retroperitoneal approach with decompression of spinal cord, cauda equina or nerve root(s), lower thoracic, lumbar, or sacral; single segment
63102	Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, lateral extracavitary approach with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s) (e.g., for tumor or retropulsed bone fragments); lumbar, single segment
Interlaminar Lumbar Instrumented Fusion (ILIF) Utilizing an Interspinous Process Fusion Device	
22899	Unlisted procedure, spine [when specified as insertion of a non-pedicle interspinous process fixation device]

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CPT Code	Description
Spinal Decompression and Interspinous Process Decompression Systems for the Treatment of Lumbar Spinal Stenosis	
22867	Insertion of interlaminar/interspinous process stabilization/distraction device, without fusion, including image guidance when performed, with open decompression, lumbar; single level [Refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Interspinous Fusion and Decompression Devices.]
22868	Insertion of interlaminar/interspinous process stabilization/distraction device, without fusion, including image guidance when performed, with open decompression, lumbar; second level (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure) [Refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Interspinous Fusion and Decompression Devices.]
22869	Insertion of interlaminar/interspinous process stabilization/distraction device, without open decompression or fusion, including image guidance when performed, lumbar; single level [Refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Interspinous Fusion and Decompression Devices.]
22870	Insertion of interlaminar/interspinous process stabilization/distraction device, without open decompression or fusion, including image guidance when performed, lumbar; second level (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure) [Refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Interspinous Fusion and Decompression Devices.]
22899	Unlisted procedure, spine [when specified as insertion of a non-pedicle interspinous process fixation device]
Percutaneous Lumbar Decompression of Nucleus Pulposus	
62287	Decompression, percutaneous, of nucleus pulposus of intervertebral disc, any method utilizing needle-based technique to remove disc material under fluoroscopic imaging or other form of indirect visualization, with discography and/or epidural injection(s) at the treated level(s), when performed, single or multiple levels, lumbar
Percutaneous Sacral Augmentation (Sacroplasty)	
0200T	Percutaneous sacral augmentation (sacroplasty), unilateral injection(s), including the use of a balloon or mechanical device, when used, 1 or more needles, includes imaging guidance and bone biopsy, when performed [Refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery Procedures.]
0201T	Percutaneous sacral augmentation (sacroplasty), bilateral injections, including the use of a balloon or mechanical device, when used, 2 or more needles, includes imaging guidance and bone biopsy, when performed [Refer to the UnitedHealthcare Commercial Medical Policy titled Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery Procedures.]
Percutaneous Minimally Invasive Fusion/Stabilization of the Sacroiliac Joint for the Treatment of Back Pain	
27279	Arthrodesis, sacroiliac joint, percutaneous or minimally invasive, with image guidance, includes obtaining bone graft when performed, unilateral; placement of transarticular device(s) and/or intra-articular device(s) piercing the lateral or medial cortices of the ilium and the lateral cortex of the sacrum
Annular Closure Devices (ACDs)	
22899	Unlisted procedure, spine
Spinal Fusion and Bone Healing Enhancement Products Including Allograft or Synthetic Bone Graft Materials	
20930	Allograft, morselized, or placement of osteopromotive material, for spine surgery only (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
20931	Allograft, structural, for spine surgery only (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
20939	Bone marrow aspiration for bone grafting, spine surgery only, through separate skin or fascial incision (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)
22899	Unlisted procedure, spine

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Diagnosis Code	Description
For CPT Code 27279	
M43.17	Spondylolisthesis, lumbosacral region
M43.18	Spondylolisthesis, sacral and sacrococcygeal region
M43.27	Fusion of spine, lumbosacral region
M43.28	Fusion of spine, sacral and sacrococcygeal region
M46.1	Sacroiliitis, not elsewhere classified
M51.17	Intervertebral disc disorders with radiculopathy, lumbosacral region
M53.2X7	Spinal instabilities, lumbosacral region
M53.2X8	Spinal instabilities, sacral and sacrococcygeal region
M53.3	Sacrococcygeal disorders, not elsewhere classified
M53.87	Other specified dorsopathies, lumbosacral region
M53.88	Other specified dorsopathies, sacral and sacrococcygeal region
M54.18	Radiculopathy, sacral and sacrococcygeal region
M99.04	Segmental and somatic dysfunction of sacral region
M99.14	Subluxation complex (vertebral) of sacral region
Q74.2	Other congenital malformations of lower limb(s), including pelvic girdle
S33.2XXA	Dislocation of sacroiliac and sacrococcygeal joint, initial encounter
S33.2XXD	Dislocation of sacroiliac and sacrococcygeal joint, subsequent encounter
S33.2XXS	Dislocation of sacroiliac and sacrococcygeal joint, sequela
S33.6XXA	Sprain of sacroiliac joint, initial encounter
S33.6XXD	Sprain of sacroiliac joint, subsequent encounter
S33.6XXS	Sprain of sacroiliac joint, sequela
S33.8XXA	Sprain of other parts of lumbar spine and pelvis, initial encounter
S33.8XXD	Sprain of other parts of lumbar spine and pelvis, subsequent encounter
S33.8XXS	Sprain of other parts of lumbar spine and pelvis, sequela

Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) Related Documents

After checking the table below and searching the Medicare Coverage Database, if no NCD, LCD, or LCA is found, refer to the criteria as noted in the Coverage Rationale section above.

NCD	LCD	Article	Contractor Type	Contractor Name
Cervical Artificial Disc Replacement				
N/A	L38033 Cervical Disc Replacement	A57021 Billing and Coding: Cervical Disc Replacement	A and B MAC	Palmetto**
Cervical Spine Fusion Surgery				
N/A	L39741 Cervical Fusion	A59608 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	CGS
	L39799 Cervical Fusion	A59674 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	First Coast
	L39758 Cervical Fusion	A59624 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	Noridian
	L39762 Cervical Fusion **Retired 09/11/2025 (See L39758)**	A59645 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion **Retired 09/11/2025 (See A59624)**	A and B MAC	Noridian

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NCD	LCD	Article	Contractor Type	Contractor Name
Cervical Spine Fusion Surgery				
N/A	L39793 Cervical Fusion	A59668 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	Novitas**
	L39773 Cervical Fusion	A59634 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	Palmetto**
	L39770 Cervical Fusion	A59632 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	Wellpoint
	L39788 Cervical Fusion	A59664 Billing and Coding: Cervical Fusion	A and B MAC	WPS*
Lumbar Spine Surgery				
N/A	L37848 Lumbar Spinal Fusion	A56396 Billing and Coding: Lumbar Spinal Fusion	A and B MAC	Palmetto**
Percutaneous Minimally Invasive Fusion/Stabilization of the Sacroiliac Joint for the Treatment of Back Pain				
N/A	L39802 Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Effective 04/17/2025**	A59682 Billing and Coding: Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Effective 04/17/2025**	A and B MAC	CGS
	L36494 Minimally-Invasive Surgical (MIS) Fusion of the Sacroiliac (SI) Joint **Retired 04/16/2025**	A56535 Billing and Coding: Minimally-Invasive Surgical (MIS) Fusion of the Sacroiliac (SI) Joint **Retired 04/16/2025**		
	L39810 Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ)	A59695 Billing and Coding: Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ)	A and B MAC	Noridian
	L39812 Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Retired 10/23/2025 (See L39810)**	A59697 Billing and Coding: Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Retired 10/23/2025 (See A59695)**	A and B MAC	Noridian
	L39797 Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Effective 04/17/2025**	A59672 Billing and Coding: Minimally Invasive Arthrodesis of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Effective 04/17/2025**	A and B MAC	Palmetto**
	L39025 Minimally Invasive Surgical (MIS) Fusion of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Retired 04/16/2025**	A58739 Billing and Coding: Minimally Invasive Surgical (MIS) Fusion of the Sacroiliac Joint (SIJ) **Retired 04/16/2025**		
	L36406 Minimally-invasive Surgical (MIS) Fusion of the Sacroiliac (SI) Joint	A57431 Billing and Coding: Minimally-invasive Surgical (MIS) Fusion of the Sacroiliac (SI) Joint	A and B MAC	Wellpoint

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NCD	LCD	Article	Contractor Type	Contractor Name
Percutaneous Minimally Invasive Fusion/Stabilization of the Sacroiliac Joint for the Treatment of Back Pain				
N/A	L36000 Percutaneous minimally invasive fusion/stabilization of the sacroiliac joint for the treatment of back pain	A57596 Billing and Coding: Percutaneous minimally invasive fusion/stabilization of the sacroiliac joint for the treatment of back pain	A and B MAC	WPS*

Medicare Administrative Contractor (MAC) With Corresponding States/Territories	
MAC Name (Abbreviation)	**States/Territories**
CGS Administrators, LLC (CGS)	KY, OH
First Coast Service Options, Inc. (First Coast)	FL, PR, VI
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC (Noridian)	AS, AK, AZ, CA, GU, HI, ID, MT, NV, ND, Northern Mariana Islands, OR, SD, UT, WA, WY
Novitas Solutions, Inc. (Novitas)	AR, CO, DC, DE, LA, MD, MS, NJ, NM, OK, PA, TX, VA**
Palmetto GBA (Palmetto)	AL, GA, NC, SC, TN, VA**, WV
Wellpoint Federal (Wellpoint)	CT, IL, ME, MA, MN, NH, NY, RI, VT, WI
Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation (WPS)*	IA, IN, KS, MI, MO, NE
Notes	
*Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation: Contract Number 05901 applies only to WPS Legacy Mutual of Omaha MAC A Providers. **For the state of Virginia: Part B services for the city of Alexandria and the counties of Arlington and Fairfax are excluded for the Palmetto GBA jurisdiction and included within the Novitas Solutions, Inc. jurisdiction.	

Policy History/Revision Information

Date	Summary of Changes
08/01/2026	• Routine review; no change to coverage guidelines • Archived previous policy version MMP089.17

Instructions for Use

The Medicare Advantage Medical Policy documents are generally used to support UnitedHealthcare coverage decisions. It is expected providers retain or have access to appropriate documentation when requested to support coverage. This document may be used as a guide to help determine applicable:

- Medical necessity coverage guidelines; including documentation requirements, and/or
- Medicare coding or billing requirements.

Medicare Advantage Medical Policies are applicable to UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Plans offered by UnitedHealthcare and its affiliates. This Medical Policy is provided for informational purposes and does not constitute medical advice. It is intended to serve only as a general reference and is not intended to address every aspect of a clinical situation. Physicians and patients should not rely on this information in making health care decisions. Physicians and patients must exercise their independent clinical discretion and judgment in determining care. Treating physicians and healthcare providers are solely responsible for determining what care to provide to their patients. Members should always consult their physician before making any decisions about medical care.

Benefit coverage for health services is determined by the member specific benefit plan document and applicable laws that may require coverage for a specific service. The member specific benefit plan document identifies which services are covered, which are excluded, and which are subject to limitations. In the event of a conflict, the member specific benefit plan document supersedes this policy. For more information on a specific member's benefit coverage, call the customer service number on the back of the member ID card or refer to the Administrative Guide.

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Medicare Advantage Medical Policies are developed as needed, are regularly reviewed, and updated, and are subject to change. They represent a portion of the resources used to support UnitedHealthcare coverage decision making. UnitedHealthcare may modify these Medical Policies at any time by publishing a new version on this website. Medicare source materials used to develop these policies may include, but are not limited to, CMS statutes, regulations, National Coverage Determinations (NCDs), Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs), and manuals. This document is not a replacement for the Medicare source materials that outline Medicare coverage requirements. The information presented in this Medical Policy is believed to be accurate and current as of the date of publication. Where there is a conflict between this document and Medicare source materials, the Medicare source materials apply. Medicare Advantage Medical Policies are the property of UnitedHealthcare. Unauthorized copying, use, and distribution of this information are strictly prohibited.

UnitedHealthcare follows Medicare coverage guidelines found in statutes, regulations, NCDs, and LCDs to determine coverage. The clinical coverage criteria governing certain items or services referenced in this Medical Policy have not been fully established in applicable Medicare guidelines because there is an absence of any applicable Medicare statutes, regulations, NCDs, or LCDs setting forth coverage criteria and/or the applicable NCDs or LCDs include flexibility that explicitly allows for coverage in circumstances beyond the specific indications that are listed in an NCD or LCD. As a result, in these circumstances, UnitedHealthcare applies internal coverage criteria as referenced in this Medical Policy. The internal coverage criteria in this Medical Policy was developed through an evaluation of the current relevant clinical evidence in acceptable clinical literature and/or widely used treatment guidelines. UnitedHealthcare evaluated the evidence to determine whether it was of sufficient quality to support a finding that the items or services discussed in the policy might, under certain circumstances, be reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis or treatment of illness or injury or to improve the functioning of a malformed body member.

Providers are responsible for submission of accurate claims. Medicare Advantage Medical Policies are intended to ensure that coverage decisions are made accurately. UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Medical Policies use Current Procedural Terminology (CPT®), Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS), or other coding guidelines. References to CPT® or other sources are for definitional purposes only and do not imply any right to reimbursement or guarantee claims payment.

For members in UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage plans where a delegate manages utilization management and prior authorization requirements, the delegate’s requirements need to be followed.

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